smother the spin. I play the sweep shot pretty well, so, ja, that's how I play against him. I can't say I've hit too many boundaries against that boy, though. Ja, one of the trickiest bowlers I've come up against.

Peter Kirsten

There's no one player whom I've specifically modelled my own game on, but as a youngster I always liked Peter Kirsten – specifically his basic cover drive. He never moved his feet all that much for the shot, but he had great hands. The way he got his hands through the ball was just amazing. The fact is that when you are playing against genuine quicks, it's not possible to get a good stride in. That 'get your foot to the ball' stuff just doesn't apply when the ball is hurtling towards you at 155km/h. What matters is how quickly you get your hands to, and through, the ball. That's what makes an opening batsman good.

This is also evident in the way Peter played the wide half-volley. His feet would never quite get there, but thanks to his hands, he'd lean back and hit through the ball. Peter was very strong with his wrists, and a lot of people say I'm quite wristy too when I play.

Obviously Peter was a hero to a youngster growing up in the Cape, but unfortunately by the time I made my senior debut, he'd already gone to Border, so I never played with him. He did coach us for a bit at Province, but by then I had already established myself as an international cricketer and he didn't have too much influence on my batting approach.

Peter is also a very nice guy – a great guy, actually; really funny too, with a dry sense of humour. He was always cracking us up. When he was coaching us he used to walk around the changing room in his underpants and long socks, with his comb tucked into his socks. I mean, how the hell can you take a coach seriously when he walks around like that?

So, Peter will always be one of my all-time favourites, simply because of his nature – he's just a phenomenal guy – and his talent as a cricketer. I've always been completely in awe when I'm in his company.

Sir Vivian Richards

I never saw Sir Viv in his prime, but I've watched his exploits on TV countless times. This guy was just a complete murderer of bowlers. He butchered them. Completely annihilated them. He could hit an away-swinger a foot outside off-stump and flick it over square leg. I'm very